

Caption everything important

Captions help people who are deaf or hard of hearing, viewers in noisy locations and users who prefer watching without sound. They also make short promotional clips understandable before anybody turns on audio.

Automatic transcription is a first draft, not a finished caption file. Correct guest names, Indian names and places, acronyms, Hindi or regional-language phrases, numbers and technical vocabulary.

Keep captions readable. Avoid covering faces and important graphics. Break long sentences into shorter phrases and time them closely to speech.

For long episodes, add chapters as well. YouTube supports video chapters that divide videos into navigable sections, while Apple Podcasts can display chapter titles within transcripts and playback interfaces.

Design once, for horizontal and vertical

A full episode and a social clip serve different purposes. The long-form version can develop an idea slowly; the clip must establish context quickly.

While framing the main episode, avoid placing important graphics at the extreme edges. This leaves room for a central 9:16 crop later.

After editing:

- **Step 1:** Mark five to ten moments that work without extensive setup.
- **Step 2:** Prioritise strong opinions, surprising facts, useful advice, humour and emotional moments.
- **Step 3:** Reframe the chosen moment vertically.
- **Step 4:** Add large, accurately corrected captions.
- **Step 5:** Remove dead time before the first meaningful sentence.
- **Step 6:** Add only enough context to make the clip understandable.

Spotify currently specifies 9:16 vertical clips of under 90 seconds, tied to an episode, and can surface them in discovery areas within the app. YouTube's thumbnail guidance likewise treats 9:16 as the native orientation for Shorts.

Publish for each platform, not just everywhere

On YouTube, a podcast is managed as a podcast playlist containing full-length video episodes. YouTube specifically advises creators not to designate playlists of clips as podcasts; keep the podcast playlist for complete episodes and organise Shorts or excerpts separately.

On Spotify, creators can upload video episodes through Spotify for Creators or supported hosting workflows. Spotify says the video plays natively on Spotify while audio can continue to other listening platforms through RSS. In May 2026, Spotify also announced work with Apple to support Apple Podcasts' HLS

THIS CHAPTER'S TASK

Film a five-minute version of your podcast using the camera you already own.

Record clean audio separately. Frame the host correctly, add one light or improve the available window light, and record a clap for synchronisation. Edit the footage into a horizontal episode, replacing camera sound with your master audio.

Next, create one vertical clip from the same recording. Add corrected captions and make sure the clip communicates its idea without requiring the full episode.

Finally, perform the most important test: play the five-minute episode with the screen turned off.

If it still works, you have made a video podcast rather than a video that accidentally replaced your podcast.

The camera should add expressions, demonstrations, identity and discovery opportunities. It should never become an excuse for weaker audio or an unsustainable production process. Begin with one camera, one good frame and one reliable recording workflow. Add angles, lights and graphics only when each addition makes the audience experience meaningfully better.

video technology through Spotify-hosting products, although it said timeline details would follow.

Apple's current HLS video system is delivered through supporting hosting providers and maintains a single integrated show page for video and audio experiences. Platform support continues to evolve, so check your host's current video-distribution options before designing a workflow around one upload.

Do a video quality-control pass

Never publish immediately after export.

Watch representative sections on a television or monitor, then on a phone. Check lip-sync, exposure, captions, camera switches and whether graphics remain readable on a small screen.

Then listen without looking at the video. Ask: If I were driving, would I understand every essential point? Have I relied on gestures, screenshots or expressions that an audio listener cannot access? Are silent visual demonstrations explained?

Apple measures listening and viewing completion for podcast episodes, while YouTube provides podcast analytics including watch time, traffic sources and audience retention. These metrics can later show whether viewers stay for the presentation rather than merely whether they clicked it. **d**